

Pronunciation

B C D F G H J L M N P R S T V W Y

C = /k/ (cake) · H = /h/ or soft rasp · J = /dʒ/ (jello) · R = /r/ flap (American butter)

Vowels: A /ɑ/ (father) · E /ɛ/ (cellar) · I /i/ (creek) · O /ɔ/ (door) · U /u/ (flu)

E and O closed like Spanish are fine too.

Stress: penultimate syllable — iLlru

1. Pronouns and Possession

	singular	plural
1st	nim I	nima we
2nd	run you	runa you (pl)
3rd	hay he / she / they	haya they (pl)

Pronouns are often dropped when context is clear. Affirmative sentences default to nim, and questions to run, so you don't repeat them as much as in English.

Possessive: pronoun before the word · for nouns, use de

nim bo = my house
bo de miwo = dog's house

2. The Four Core Markers

a [subject] · i [verb] · e [direct object] · u [indirect object]

Mnemonics: Actor · Initiates · Engaged · Unto

a nim i anona e mocen u run
I give chocolate to you

More often (nim dropped in affirmative): i anona e mocen u run

You may drop markers when context is clear. a drops the easiest, and then e.

a...a means is / are:

a hay a yalen = he/she/they is tall · a bo a yamirli = the house is old
Word order is flexible because roles are marked: e mocen u run i anona is also common.

3. Describing Words

A modifier goes right before the word it describes.

mocen mouje = chocolate drink
pohem mocen mouje = hot chocolate drink

4. Two Core Prepositions

en = location / time ("in, on, at")

de = source / possession ("of, from")

a run en bo = you are at home
a hay i anifi de bo = he/she/they comes from the house

5. Coordination and Contrast

su	and / with	run i mo e moaria su mocen	you eat apple and chocolate
mai	but	hay i anvu, mai nim i doum	she goes, but I don't
dou	or	nim i mo e moaria dou mocen	I eat apple or chocolate
eta	so, therefore	a nim a tou, eta nim i bonfene	I'm tired, so I lie down

6. Negation

Add -um to the word you want to negate.

i dami a moaria = there is an apple
i damium a moaria = there is no apple

7. Questions and "what/that" Clauses

Raise intonation for yes/no questions. No structural change.

run i mo? = are you eating?

ce = what (question) · ca = that / which (connector)

ce en bo? = what's in the house?

Build more question words with ce + a domain word:

word	meaning
cei	who (what + person)
cedom	where (what + place)
celi	when (what + time)
ceora	why (what + reason)
cenon	how (what + way)

In statements, swap ce → ca: ceora → caora (because) · cedom → cadom (where) · etc.

run i ilianum cadom bo = you know-not where the house

8. Verb Stacking

To chain two verbs, repeat i before each one. No "to" needed.

run i dairan i anelem en bo = you like to stay home
hay i do i mo = he/she/they can eat
haya i dai i anvu = they want to go

9. Compounds

-a suffix bonds modifiers and noun into a single concept:

waa jasru	waa (sea) + jasru (bend)	= bay
lufua bei	lufua (air) + bei (vehicle)	= airplane
yalgaia mus	yalgaia (small) + mus (bug)	= ant
waa dom	waa (sea) + dom (land)	= island

Hyphenated forms fuse two words into one expression:

falen-li	falen (child) + li (time)	= childhood
tohpu-vanvu	tohpu (sad) + vanvu (walk)	= to trudge
bo-bortal	bo (house) + bortal (enter)	= to enter a house

If you're unsure which form to use, just use whatever feels right. Chances are, either works!

10. Vocabulary

Most Oravia words are formed as (sub)cluster + root. A cluster is the first sound(s) and signals the semantic domain; a root adds a second layer of meaning.

moalen (banana) = MO (food) + A (fruit subcluster) + LEN (root: long)

~260 (sub)clusters and roots were discovered using word-embeddings. Once you know the patterns, you can make educated guesses and learn words faster.

Starter Vocabulary

mo	eat / food	mouje	drink	mocen	chocolate	mogali	coffee
moaria	apple	bo	house	miau	cat	beivu	car
leirih	tree	falen	child	fare	parent	faejor	woman
faejal	man	faibor	spouse	eofa	friend	elihei	person
anye	make, do	anvu	go	anona	give	anifou	need
ando	can	none	have	anidai	want	dami	exist
dairan	like	ilian	know	ilaluan	speak	vardei	see
elemi	live, life	yuba	good	ti	bad	yalen	tall / long
litam	day	limel	night	liyar	morning	noli	now
gerina	money / to buy	noi	here / this	ho noi	there / that	oipoh	exciting

A AN	action		ELA	religious	JAH	cutting tools
ANE	static movement		ELE	Aramaic Elah	JAS	Japanese 刃 (ha)
ANI	movement towards		ELI	self-expansion	JE	gripping/fastening tools
ANO	movement away		ELO	Greek eleutheros	JEN	Japanese hasamu
APA	physical movement		EO	virtue	JEO	geometrics
AS	involuntary bodily functions		EOD	Greek ethikos	JO	Mandarin jié
ASE	affectionate contact		EOM	prosocial	JOL	location
ASI	orifice intake/expulsion		F	Latin eloqui	JU	Japanese 前 (mae)
ASU	involuntary vocal acts		FA	social	JUI	geometric positions
B			FAE	Greek eu-	LA	Greek geo-
BE	travel		FAI	social interactions	LAN	materials
BEI	vehicles		FAL	Japanese deau	LE	Korean jaeryo
BO	home interior		FE	events and gatherings	LEA	material types
BOE	house spaces		FENE	Korean moim	LEI	deceive
BON	furniture		FI	family relationships	LEM	Hindi jhūth
BOR	house structure		FOU	Latin familia	LEN	temporary
BOS	hygiene fixtures		FU	gender	LENO	Hindi jugār
C			G	partnership, marriage	LI	happiness
CAI	flat		GA	Latin foedus	LIA	cross-lingual
CATI	constraint		GAI	young ones	LIL	balance
CE	what?		GALI	Latin filia	LIMEL	Hindi saṃtulana
CI	sharp		GAN	halting	LIRA	round, around
CIU	creative products		GAO	Turkish fren	LIU	environment
CO	communication		GE	rest	LOA	PIE *lendh-
COU	written communication		GEL	inside	LU	landscape
D			GI	Swahili -fika	LUA	English lea
DA	evaluation		GO	lack	LUAN	plants
DAE	epistemic		H	lightness	LUFU	Mandarin lěi
DAL	pattern		HAI	Mandarin fú	LUN	keeping
DAN	emphasis		HE	evaluation	M	Greek lēm̐ma
DAN	options		HEH	English gauge	MA	long
DAO	serious		HEI	small	MAE	Latin longus
DAU	distance		HELA	English grain	MAL	ground
DE	origin, from		HOU	coffee	MAS	Spanish llano
DEL	logic		HUI	Arabic qahwa	MI	time
DI	stripe, finger		I	ranking	MIE	Mandarin 假 (jià)
DO	regulations		IL	Japanese 格 (kaku)	MIO	resonant
DOH	enforcement		ILA	value assessment	MIR	Hindi laya
DOI	opposing		ILI	finances	MIR	muscle
DOM	place		ILO	Proto-Gmc *geldan	MIR	Arabic lif
DON	show		J	trading	MIR	evening
DORA	bond		JA	German Geld	MIR	Arabic layl
DUR	hardness		JAE	boldness	MIR	mark
	Latin durus			half	MIR	Latin littera
				Japanese 五 (go)	MIR	clock time
				message	MIR	Greek lepto
				Swahili habari	MIR	other
				fiction tropes	MIR	Latin alius
				Greek heros	MIR	completeness
				antagonist tropes	MIR	Hawaiian loa
				protagonist tropes	MIR	atmosphere, outside
				projecting outward	MIR	Latin lux
				Sanskrit hel	MIR	flow
				warmth	MIR	Arabic lujja
				background	MIR	tongue
				fire	MIR	Arabic liṣān
				Polynesian ahi	MIR	air
				shadow	MIR	German Luft
				Mandarin hòu	MIR	seasons
				ethereal	MIR	Latin luna
				Mandarin hún	MIR	
				objects of inquiry	MIR	
				Latin ille	MIR	
				sharing information	MIR	
				Arabic ilā	MIR	
				cognition	MIR	
				Port. inteligência	MIR	
				uncertain knowledge	MIR	
				English illusion	MIR	
					MIR	

●● MO	food, eating	● ROE	formal education	● VARI	back
● MOA	Hawaiian moku	● ROU	Latin rogare	● VEI	health issues
● MOL	fruits	● RU	written knowledge	● VEL	Sanskrit vaidya
●● MU	Polynesian moa	● RUL	Latin rotulus	● VER	medical treatments
● MUH	food containers		bend	●● VI	Latin valere
	smaller animals		Arabic rukū'		safety
	Swahili mdudu		habit		German Wehr
	flying animals		English rule		interior body
	Persian morph				Latin vita
N		S			
● NA	giving	● SAR	hang	● VIO	change, exchange
● NALA	Proto-Bantu *-nab-	● SARI	Turkish sarmak	● VIR	Latin via
● NE	urgency	● SAU	sun	● VIR	organs
● NEN	Arabic nafara	● SE	Sanskrit sūrya	● VOA	Latin viscera
● NI	quantifiers	● SEL	start	● VON	method
● NIU	Swahili na	● SEM	Hindi surū	● VOR	constraint
● NO	power and violence	● SERI	machines	● VU	Mandarin wéi
● NON	Latin imponens	● SIO	Mandarin shèbèi	● VUSON	external body
● NOR	new	● SIO	coding		threat
● NOU	Hindi nayā	● SOI	English select		English horror
● NU	some	● SU	system		cleaning actions
	Tagalog niyon	● SUS	Greek systema		Swahili -osha
	function words		series		movement
	Latin non		Latin series		Mandarin bù
	path		processes		slow movement
	relation to reference		PIE *sekʷ-		vu + son
	Latin norma		games	W	
	low, falling		Latin iocus	●● WA	sea, water bodies
	Arabic nawm		document	● WI	Polynesian wai
	limit		speed	● WIL	geographical orientation
	Greek nu		alongside	● WIM	Arabic wayn
O			hearing	● WOL	human-made geography
● ODU	top	T	Latin auscultare		Latin villa
● OI	fun	● TA			natural geography
	Yiddish oy	● TAI	hand		wide
● OM	music	● TAL	Latin tangere	Y	
● ORA	Sanskrit om	● TALE	guide	● YA	objective qualities
P	idea	● TAM	Mandarin dài	● YAH	Swahili -a
● PA	paper	● TAN	door	● YAL	representation, invitation
● PAI	Latin papyrus	● TAR	Persian tāq	● YEN	texture qualities
● PARO	foot	● TEL	passage	● YES	size qualities
● PILI	Hindi pair	● TER	Welsh taith	● YO	Arabic ṭawīl
● PO	one		one		light
● POA	Arabic tamām		big	● YAR	Arabic ḍiyā'
● POH	Greek titān		regulate	● YE	clothing and fabric
● POI	Arabic tartīb		image	● YEL	Turkish yelken
● POPO	moment		English television		joining
● PU	count		moment		English yoke
● PUNI	Latin ter		count		printed
● PUPI	harm, damage		Latin ter		Mandarin yìn
	Tamil ti		harm, damage		garments
R			Tamil ti		colors
● RA	fungus		types of harm		Yoruba yọ
● RAI	Sanskrit tīvra		Sanskrit tīvra		sky and ocean
● RAM	suffering, distress		Indonesian tobat		oscillate
● RAN	emotional suffering		emotional suffering		onomatopoeia
● RAS	English torment		English torment		subjective qualities
● REL	interpersonal suffering		interpersonal suffering		personal characteristics
● REN	physical depletion		physical depletion		mist
● REVA	conflict		conflict		Mandarin yún
● RIH	Latin tumultus		Latin tumultus		
● RO	crash		crash		
	English tumble		English tumble		
	weapons		weapons		
	Indonesian tombak		Indonesian tombak		
		V			
		● VA	core		
		● VABO	Sanskrit vāyu		
		● VAL	cozy, body home		
		● VAN	va + bo		
		● VAN	ice		
		● VAR	Italian valanga		
			limbs		
			Hindi bāṃh		
			private		
			face		
			Sanskrit vaktram		